Operation Sandy Lift

F/A-18C Hornet · 1–2 players · Caucasus · rescue escort (Sandy) · cold start and recovery aboard CVN-74

Search party	moves **08:50**, reaches the pilot about 09:24	**Survivor**	Fields north-west of Ochamchire
Rescue helo	DODGE 1-1 (SH-60B), called in from F10	**Weapons**	Maverick F, Mk-20 Rockeye, GBU-12
Overhead	PONTIAC (MQ-9), laser 1688	**Threats**	SA-13, 2× ZSU-23-4, ZU-23, Igla; MiG-21s
Mother	CVN-74 · 127.5 · TACAN 74X · ICLS 11	**Support**	ARCO, CHEVY CAP, MAGIC

Situation

CAG's orders are short: "We don't leave people." He has released DODGE, a rescue helicopter, and your section to bring the pilot home. If the pilot on the ground is from your own section, the squadron has a spare jet and a spare pilot on the schedule; in multiplayer, Enfield 1-2 flies that seat.

A Hornet went down near Ochamchire during Narrow Gate. The pilot is on the ground, uninjured and hiding in the fields north-west of town, about 2 nm from the fuel depot. A Red search party is 4.4 km away at the edge of town: a BTR-80, a ZU-23 on a truck, and riflemen with an Igla. It starts toward the pilot at about **08:50**, and at its pace it reaches them around **09:24**.

The depot's short-range defences are still there: two ZSU-23-4s and an SA-13, and the SA-13 can reach the pickup site. The SA-6 is not. PONTIAC watched what was left of the battery pack up and drive off north-east within an hour of the strike. Mobile SAMs move once they have been seen.

Mission

You are SANDY. Clear the area around the pilot, bring DODGE in, and keep the helicopter alive until it is back aboard Mother.

DODGE 1-1, an SH-60B, is holding over the water 14 nm west of the survivor, about 7 minutes away. Call it in from the F10 menu when the area is clear. DODGE lands next to the survivor, needs 40 seconds on the ground, then flies home. Keep the search party off the pilot and the guns off the helicopter.

DODGE goes when you call, clean LZ or not, and warns you if threats are still close. Call too late and the search party gets there first: the last call that still beats them is about **09:16**.

Air threat

Two MiG-21s come looking from Gudauta at about 09:10. MAGIC will commit CHEVY when they launch, and you can ask for cover over the survivor's area from the F10 menu. If CHEVY is out of missiles, short of fuel, down to one jet or lost, Mother launches her alert-5, UZI, two more Hornets: about 12 minutes to station, and only one section.

What happens next

Result	Needs
Success	DODGE lands aboard Mother with the survivor
Failure	The survivor is captured, or DODGE is lost

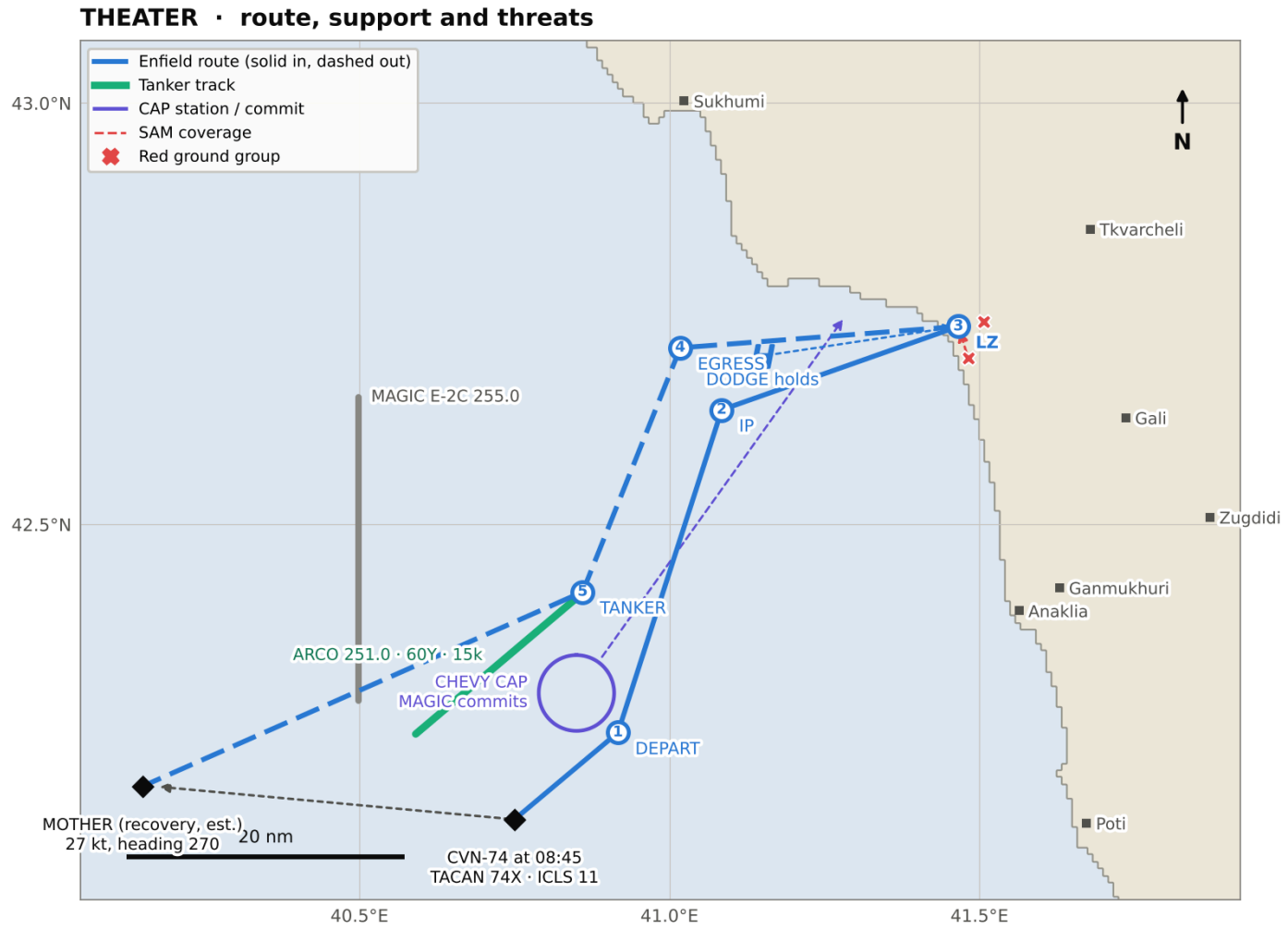
Secondary objective, **clean recovery**: every Sandy jet traps aboard Mother with at least about 2,000 lb of fuel, and nobody is lost. The summary comes once DODGE and both jets are down.

1 or 2 players, cold start on the deck. Enfield 1-1 is flyable in single player.

Key times

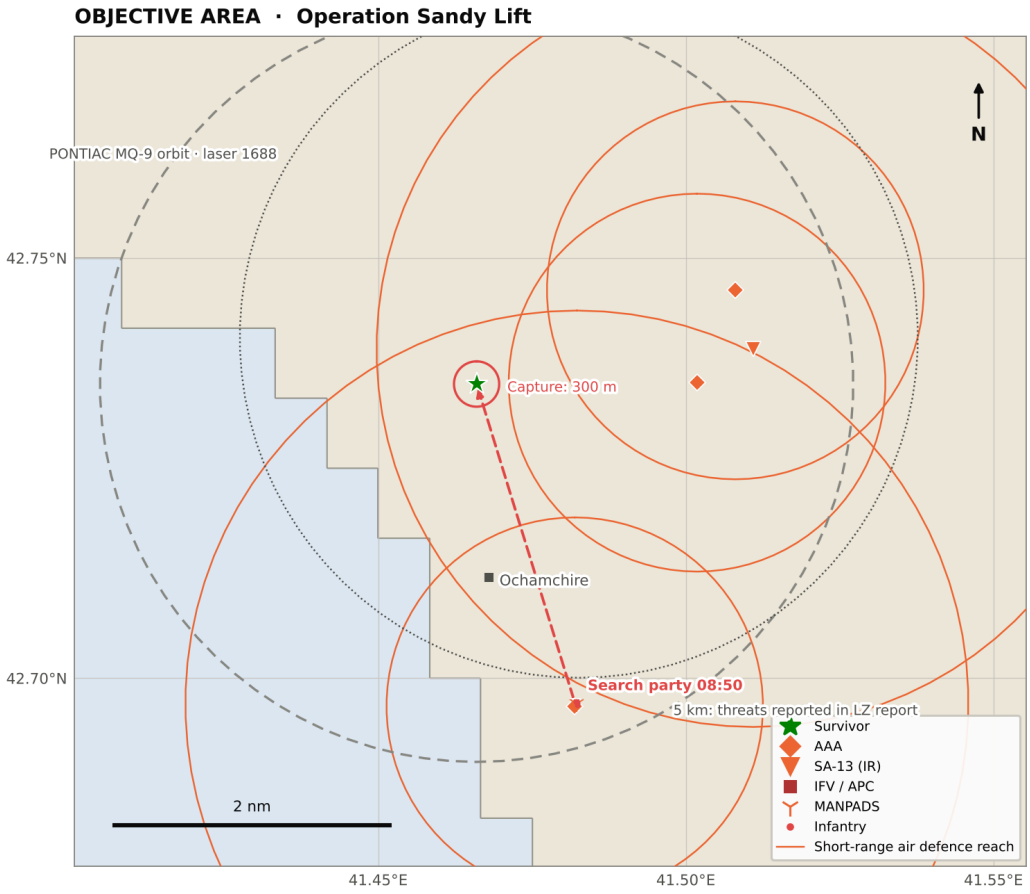
Event	Local
Mission start, cold on the deck	08:45
Search party starts moving	08:50
Red MiG-21 pair launches	09:10
Latest DODGE call (7 min transit and 40 s on the ground, estimate)	**09:16**
Search party reaches the survivor, if untouched (estimate)	09:24

MAP 1



Coastline is approximate (about 1 km resolution). Courses are true. MOTHER is the carrier's estimated position at recovery. She steams west at 27 kt, so trust TACAN 74X over the waypoint.

MAP 2



Rescue sequence

Step	You	What happens
1	Pontiac: LZ report	Survivor coordinates, how far off the search party is, threats within 5 km
2	Kill what threatens the helicopter	The air defence near the pickup site, then the ZU-23 and Igla with the search party
3	Stop the search party	If it gets within 300 m of the survivor, the pilot is captured
4	CALL IN DODGE	DODGE pushes, about 7 min, and warns you if threats remain
5	Cover the pickup	40 s on the ground next to the survivor's green smoke
6	Escort DODGE home	DODGE lands on Mother; the summary follows when DODGE and both jets are down

Times and route

The search party moves at 08:50 local and reaches the survivor at about 09:24 if nothing stops it. Latest DODGE call about 09:16. MiG-21s at 09:10.

WP	Name	Coordinates	Alt	Leg	Course
0	CVN-74 (deck)	N 42°09.000′ E 040°45.000′	deck		
1	DEPART	N 42°15.184′ E 040°55.011′	5,000 ft	9.7 nm	050°
2	IP	N 42°38.160′ E 041°05.056′	15,000 ft	24.2 nm	018°
3	LZ	N 42°44.100′ E 041°27.960′	15,000 ft	17.9 nm	070°
4	EGRESS	N 42°42.578′ E 041°01.047′	15,000 ft	19.8 nm	266°
5	TANKER	N 42°25.200′ E 040°51.600′	15,000 ft	18.7 nm	202°
6	MOTHER (land)	N 42°11.352′ E 040°08.986′	deck	34.4 nm	247°

Loadout

Both jets: 2× AGM-65F Maverick, 2× Mk-20 Rockeye, 2× GBU-12, LITENING, 2× AIM-9X, AIM-120C, tank.

Station	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
1-1	AIM-9X	AGM-65F Maverick	2 x Mk-20 Rockeye	LITENING pod	FPU-8A tank 330 gal	AIM-120C	2 x GBU-12	AGM-65F Maverick	AIM-9X
1-2	AIM-9X	AGM-65F Maverick	2 x Mk-20 Rockeye	LITENING pod	FPU-8A tank 330 gal	AIM-120C	2 x GBU-12	AGM-65F Maverick	AIM-9X

Comms and navigation

Callsign	Role	Frequency	Notes
MOTHER	CVN-74 John C. Stennis	127.5 AM	TACAN 74X STN · ICLS 11
ENFIELD 1-1, 1-2	You, flying Sandy	251.0 AM	Flight frequency, shared with ARCO
ARCO	S-3B tanker, 15,000 ft	251.0 AM	TACAN 60Y
MAGIC	E-2C, controls CHEVY and UZI	255.0 AM	
PONTIAC	MQ-9 over the survivor	F10 menu	Laser 1688
DODGE	SH-60B rescue helicopter	F10 call-in	Holds 14 nm west of the survivor
CHEVY	2× F/A-18C CAP, 20,000 ft	MAGIC commits	Fleet defence comes first
UZI	2× F/A-18C alert-5 on Mother	Via MAGIC	About 12 min to the CAP station

F10 radio menu: Sandy Lift

Item	What it does
Pontiac: LZ report	Survivor position, search party, threats within 5 km, DODGE status
Survivor: pop green smoke	Marks the survivor
CALL IN DODGE (rescue helo)	Sends the helicopter in
Request CAP cover	Asks MAGIC for CHEVY over the survivor’s area. Approved only if CHEVY is free
Pontiac laser > nearest threat, terminate	Laser on the closest ground threat to the pickup site, code 1688

Item	What it does
Mission summary now	Outcome on demand